

Session 5 — Dagesh: Forte vs. Lene

BBH 2026.1 · Ch3 Review · 10 items

For each word, a target letter with a dagesh is shown. Identify whether the dagesh is Forte or Lene and state the reason.
Key rule: if the letter is NOT a Begadkephat (bet gimel dalet kaf pe tav), any dagesh must be Forte.

Exercise — 10 items

#	Word	Target	Forte or Lene?	Reason
1	הַשָּׁמַיִם	שׁ		
2	בְּרֵאשִׁית	בּ		
3	כִּי	כּ		
4	הַמָּיִם	מּ		
5	תּוֹרָה	תּ		
6	מִשְׁפָּט	פּ		
7	גּוֹי	גּ		
8	יִיזְרָאֵל	יּ		
9	הַפָּנִים	פּ		
10	דָּבָר	דּ		

Answer Key

#	Word	Target	Type	Reason
1	הַשְּׁמִים	שׁ		
✓	הַשְּׁמִים	שׁ	Forte	Shin is not Begadkephat → Forte; article assimilation
2	בְּרֵאשִׁית	בּ		
✓	בְּרֵאשִׁית	בּ	Lene	Begadkephat in word-initial position → Lene (hard b)
3	כִּי	כּ		
✓	כִּי	כּ	Lene	Begadkephat in word-initial position → Lene (hard k)
4	הַמֵּים	מׁ		
✓	הַמֵּים	מׁ	Forte	Mem is not Begadkephat → Forte; article assimilation
5	תּוֹרָה	תּ		
✓	תּוֹרָה	תּ	Lene	Begadkephat in word-initial position → Lene (hard t)
6	מִשְׁפָּט	פּ		
✓	מִשְׁפָּט	פּ	Forte	Begadkephat but follows closed syllable מִשׁ → Forte
7	גּוֹי	גּ		
✓	גּוֹי	גּ	Lene	Begadkephat in word-initial position → Lene (hard g)
8	וַיִּקְרָא	יׁ		
✓	וַיִּקְרָא	יׁ	Forte	Yod is not Begadkephat → Forte; Wayyiqtol prefix doubling
9	הַפְּנִים	פּ		
✓	הַפְּנִים	פּ	Forte	Begadkephat but follows article assimilation הַ → Forte
10	דְּבַר	דּ		
✓	דְּבַר	דּ	Lene	Begadkephat in stem-initial position → Lene (hard d)